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handmade crochet patterns

Little Duck Plushie

A round, squashy duckling in fluffy chenille, worked as a single piece from tail to crown - no body-to-head seam. Only the wings and the beak are sewn on.

Embroidered eyes

Confident beginner

1.5 - 2 hours



FINISHED SIZE

- About 16 cm (6.25 in) tall and 7.5 cm (3 in) wide in super-bulky chenille (#6) on a 4.5 mm hook.
- One seamless body; 2 wings + 1 beak to sew.

Design Code NS 05

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PATTERN OVERVIEW

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SAFETY FIRST

This duck uses EMBROIDERED eyes, which avoids the small-parts hazard of safety eyes - a real advantage if you sell finished toys. If you sell them as toys, EU items need CE marking under EN 71 and US items must meet CPSIA and ASTM F963; independent testing is the only way to confirm. Check seams hold under a firm pull and that the chenille pile does not shed, and tag each piece with materials, your maker name and an age recommendation.

MATERIALS

- Body yarn: super-bulky chenille (#6), yellow, about 25-35 g. A 100 g ball makes two ducks comfortably. Fluffy chenille is the whole look.
- Details: a small amount of orange yarn for the beak; black yarn or embroidery floss for the eyes.
- Hook: 4.5 mm (US 7).
- Stuffing & notions: fibre fill about 25-35 g packed firmly; yarn needle, stitch marker, pins.

GAUGE

Gauge: about 8 mm per stitch and 7 mm per round in super-bulky chenille. Chenille varies between brands, so measure a 12-stitch swatch (about 10 cm) first. Finished size: about 16 cm tall and 7.5 cm wide - 23 rounds at 7 mm and a widest point of 30 stitches at 8 mm.

ABBREVIATIONS

MR magic ring

ch chain

sc single crochet

inc increase (2 sc in one st)

dec invisible decrease

sl st slip stitch

FLO front loops only

FO fasten off

(n) stitch count

CONSTRUCTION & TECHNIQUES

Work in a continuous spiral - no join, no chain 1 between rounds - with a marker in the first stitch of every round.

1. Magic ring & spiral

The start of the body and each wing is a magic ring. Work in a continuous spiral - no join, no chain 1 between rounds - with a marker in the first stitch of every round.

2. Invisible decrease

Insert the hook under the FRONT loop only of the next two stitches, yarn over and pull through the first two loops (three loops on the hook), then yarn over and pull through both remaining loops. A flatter join than a standard decrease - it shows at this scale.

3. Around a chain (the beak)

The beak is worked around both sides of a starting chain: along one side, corner increases into the end chain, then back along the other side. Rnd 1 of a 5-chain totals 11 stitches; all five chains are used.

4. Through both layers

To close each flat wing, fold it and single-crochet across both layers at once - 6 sc take the 12 stitches down to 6 and leave a flat half-disc.

5. Embroidery & sewing

The eyes are embroidered (no safety eyes). The wings and the flattened, unstuffed beak are sewn on; sew through a whole stitch so they cannot pull out.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Body - yellow chenille

The waist at R10-R12 and the reflare at R13-R14 separate body from head with no seam. Body and head are the same diameter (30 stitches, about 76 mm); the 18-stitch waist reads as the neck. Start stuffing at R10 - once the waist closes you cannot reach the body.

Rnd	Instruction	Sts	Note
R1	6 sc in MR	(6)	-
R2	inc in each st around	(12)	-
R3	[sc, inc] x 6	(18)	-
R4	[2 sc, inc] x 6	(24)	-
R5	[3 sc, inc] x 6	(30)	body full width
R6	sc in each st around	(30)	wings attach R6 - R9
R7	sc in each st around	(30)	-
R8	sc in each st around	(30)	-
R9	sc in each st around	(30)	-
R10	[3 sc, dec] x 6	(24)	START STUFFING NOW
R11	sc in each st around	(24)	-
R12	[2 sc, dec] x 6	(18)	waist closing
R13	[2 sc, inc] x 6	(24)	-
R14	[3 sc, inc] x 6	(30)	head begins
R15	sc in each st around	(30)	-
R16	sc in each st around	(30)	eyes at R16 - R17
R17	sc in each st around	(30)	-
R18	sc in each st around	(30)	beak across R16 - R18

Rnd	Instruction	Sts	Note
R19	sc in each st around	(30)	-
R20	[3 sc, dec] x 6	(24)	-
R21	[2 sc, dec] x 6	(18)	stuff head, shape cheeks
R22	[sc, dec] x 6	(12)	add final stuffing
R23	dec x 6	(6)	close via FLO

Finish: FO with a long tail; thread through the FLO of the 6 remaining stitches, pull tight, knot and bury.

Smaller head option: skip the R14 flare (keep R14-R19 at 24) and close with R20 [2 sc, dec] x 6 (18), R21 [sc, dec] x 6 (12), R22 dec x 6 (6).

2. Wings - yellow chenille (make 2)

Rnd	Instruction	Sts	Note
R1	6 sc in MR	(6)	-
R2	inc in each st around	(12)	-
R3	sc in each st around	(12)	-
R4	sc in each st around	(12)	flatten, sc 6 across both layers

Do not stuff. Flatten and sc 6 across both layers to close (12 sts to 6), leaving a flat half-disc about 30 mm across. Sew to the sides spanning R6-R9, angled slightly back.

3. Beak - orange (make 1, worked around a chain)

Rnd	Instruction	Sts	Note
Found	ch 5	-	-
Rnd 1	from the 2nd ch: sc in next 3, 3 sc in last ch, rotate, sc in next 3, 2 sc in last loop	(11)	-
Rnd 2	inc, 2 sc, inc, 2 sc, inc, 2 sc, inc, sc	(15)	-

Sl st and FO with a long tail. Do NOT stuff - flatten it to a flat lens. As written it is a bold ~50 mm cartoon beak; for a daintier duck work Rnd 1 only (11 sts, about 37 mm).

FINISHING & ASSEMBLY

- Face & assembly - work in this order:
 1. Stuff from R10: fill the body firmly as the waist begins to close - the neck narrows fast.
 2. Eyes: embroider black eyes between R16 and R17, about 7-8 stitches apart (56-64 mm around the 76 mm head), before the head closes.
 3. Beak: pin horizontally across R16-R18, centred between the eyes, and sew around the outer edge.
 4. Wings: sew one to each side at R6-R9, angled slightly back.
 5. Close: top up stuffing through R22, then close via the FLO and bury the end.
- The flat orange beak and embroidered eyes - no plastic parts, so a safer seller.

TROUBLESHOOTING

- **Much taller than 16 cm.**

Your chenille is thicker than gauge. A 12-stitch swatch at 10 mm per stitch finishes near 20 cm.

- **Much shorter.**

Finer yarn - see the size table; DK on 3.0 mm gives 7-8 cm, not 10-12.

- **Wings sit on the neck.**

Too high. R6-R9 is the body; R10-R12 is the waist.

- **Beak leaves a gap / puffs.**

Each side must use four chains (no chain left over). Do not stuff; flatten before pinning.

- **Stuffing shows / head flops.**

Hook too large for the yarn, or the waist was under-packed. Pack R10-R12 firmly before the reflare.

- **Cannot reach the body to stuff.**

You started too late - begin at R10 while the waist is still 24 stitches wide.

HELPFUL TIPS

Making a smaller duck

Yarn	Finished height
Velvet / bulky (#5) - 3.0 mm hook	10 - 12 cm
Aran / worsted (#4)	9 - 10 cm
DK / light worsted (#3)	7.5 - 8.5 cm

Care

Surface clean with a damp cloth and mild soap; do not machine wash - chenille mats and sheds in agitation. Dry flat away from heat, and fluff the pile with a clean pet slicker brush once dry.

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Safety reminder

Eyes are embroidered (no small plastic parts). Finished toys sold for children must still meet local toy-safety laws (EN 71 / CE in the EU; CPSIA and ASTM F963 in the US) - independent testing confirms compliance. Secure every seam and check the chenille does not shed.

Happy crocheting!

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